



Incident handler's journal

Date: July 10, 2026	Entry: 1
Description	A ransomware attack on a small U.S. healthcare clinic caused major disruption to business operations, preventing employees from accessing critical patient files and medical records.
Tool(s) used	None (incident documentation only)
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. ● Who caused the incident? ○ An organized group of unethical hackers known to target organizations in the healthcare and transportation industries caused the incident. ● What happened? ○ Employees received phishing emails containing malicious attachments. Once downloaded, the malware installed ransomware that encrypted all critical files on the company's systems. A ransom note was displayed demanding payment in exchange for the decryption key. ● When did the incident occur? ○ The incident occurred on a Tuesday morning at approximately 9:00 a.m. ● Where did the incident happen? ○ The incident occurred at a small U.S. healthcare clinic that specializes in primary-care services. ● Why did the incident happen?

	○ The attackers exploited employees through targeted phishing emails. The lack of employee awareness and insufficient email security controls allowed the malicious attachment to be downloaded, giving attackers access to the network.
Additional notes	It would be important to determine how many employees clicked the phishing email and whether the company had any email filtering or security awareness training in place. Could stronger MFA or endpoint protection have prevented this attack?